STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE (SOP1) REGARDING PRE-MELA COUNSELLING FOR ANTYODAYA MELAS UNDER MUKHYAMANTRI ANTYODAYA PARIVAR UTTHAN YOJANA (MMAPUY) 2.0

1. Background

The Antyodaya Parivar Utthan Melas under Mukhyamantri Antyodaya Parivar Utthan Yojana (MMAPUY) 2.0 shall be organized across the State in a round-wise manner to ensure systematic, targeted, and efficient outreach to eligible beneficiary families.The objective of these Antyodaya Melas under MMAPUY 2.0 is to facilitate on-the-spot counselling, scheme allocation, application processing, and financial linkage for identified Antyodaya families. This is to ensure minimal pendency and maximum benefit delivery under different schemes. The Additional Deputy Commissioners-cum-Antyodaya Utthan Adhikari shall serve as the Overall Nodal Officer for the implementation and monitoring of MMAPUY 2.0 at the district level.

The Constituency Nodal Officers shall be primarily responsible for ensuring conduct of effective Pre-Mela Counselling prior to the Melas.The purpose of Pre-Mela Counselling is to inform invited beneficiaries about the objectives of MMAPUY, guide them regarding suitable schemes based on their interests and capabilities, and ensure that they attend the Mela with the required documents and information. It must be ensured that Pre-Mela Counselling is conducted in a structured and systematic manner so as to achieve a high beneficiary turnout at the Melas.

2. Objectives of Pre-Mela Counselling

The key objectives of Pre-Mela Counselling are as follows:

- To inform the invited Antyodaya families about the purpose and benefits of MMAPUY.
- To guide beneficiaries regarding suitable schemes based on their skills, interests, and livelihood requirements.
- To ensure that beneficiaries attend the Antyodaya Melas with the necessary documents and information.
- To improve preparedness of beneficiaries and reduce delays during the Mela process.
- To maximize beneficiary participation and ensure effective scheme delivery.

3. Roles and Responsibilities

The **Additional Deputy Commissioners (ADCs)-cum-Antyodaya Utthan Adhikari** shall serve as overall Nodal Officer for proper implementation and monitoring of the Pre-Mela Counselling process in their respective districts. The Constituency Nodal officers shall coordinate with ADCs and update them about the progress and status of Pre-Mela counselling.

The Constituency Nodal officers responsibilities shall include:

- Planning and scheduling Pre-Mela Counselling activities.
- Constituting and training Pre-Mela Counselling Teams.
- Ensuring coverage of all invited families.
- Monitoring the progress and quality of pre-mela counselling activities.
- Ensuring that the status of pre-mela counselling is updated on the MMAPUY Portal.

4. Scheduling and Monitoring of Pre-Mela Counselling on the Portal

The list of invited beneficiary families for the Antyodaya Melas will be available on the **MMAPUY Portal** through the district login.

District officials shall perform the following steps through District login:

I. View/Download the list of invited beneficiary families from the portal by selecting the Constituency/Block/MC
II. Create clusters/groups of villages or urban wards for organizing pre-mela counselling.
III. Schedule dates for conducting counselling activities for each village/ward/cluster.
IV. Update the counselling schedule on the portal.
V. After completion of Pre-mela counselling, update the number of families covered for each cluster/village/ward.

The purpose of this portal functionality is to track whether Pre-Mela Counselling has been conducted across all villages and wards and to ensure complete coverage of invited families.

5. Mode of Conducting Pre-Mela Counselling

District Administrations may adopt suitable methods for conducting Pre-Mela Counselling depending upon local conditions. These may include:

- Door-to-door counselling
- Cluster-based counselling sessions
- Group meetings at village or ward level
- Interaction through community institutions
- Telephonic Mode

It is recommended that counselling be conducted **primarily through in-person interactions**, so that beneficiaries can clearly understand the scheme options and raise queries.

During counselling, beneficiaries should be:

- Informed about the objective of MMAPUY,
- Briefed about relevant schemes under MMAPUY,
- Guided regarding the most suitable scheme options,
- Advised regarding the documents required for participation in the Mela.
- Districts may also disseminate the information through additional communication channels to ensure maximum participation.

6. Formation and Training of Pre-Mela Counselling Teams

The **Additional Deputy Commissioners-cum-Antyodaya Utthan Adhikari** shall constitute Pre-Mela Counselling Teams in coordination with Constituency Nodal officers using available field-level staff and officials.

These teams shall be trained before deployment to ensure that they are familiar with:

- The objectives of MMAPUY
- The major schemes available under the programme
- Eligibility criteria for the schemes
- Documents required for applications
- The counselling process to be followed with beneficiaries

7. Content of Pre-Mela Counselling

During the counselling process, the teams shall:

- Explain the objective and benefits of MMAPUY.
- Inform beneficiaries about different categories of schemes available under the programme, such as:
    - Loan-based self-employment schemes
    - Wage employment opportunities
    - Skill development training programmes

- Assess the beneficiary's background, skills, and livelihood preferences.
- Suggest suitable scheme options that may help the beneficiary generate sustainable income.
- Inform beneficiaries about the documents required for participation in the Mela.
- Beneficiaries should also be clearly informed that the final application process and scheme allocation will take place during the Antyodaya Mela.

8. Support from Field Functionaries

District Administrations may take support from field-level functionaries and community institutions to ensure effective outreach. These may include:

- Local government functionaries
- Community-based organizations
- Other trained field personnel

Such support may help improve coordination, monitoring, and effective dissemination of information among target beneficiaries. During pre-mela counselling, beneficiaries should be advised to attend the Mela with the documents like Family ID, Aadhaar Card, Caste Certificate, Educational Qualification Certificates, Passport-size photographs etc.

9. Expected Outcome

Effective Pre-Mela Counselling will ensure that:

- Beneficiaries attend the Melas with proper understanding of scheme options
- More turnout of eligible families in Mela
- Documentation is complete at the time of application
- Scheme mapping becomes faster and more accurate
- Applications are processed efficiently on the Mela day